

AGREEMENT FOR LEGAL SERVICES

Attorney review required. This is a starting form, not legal advice. Fee, trust-account, contingency, and client-communication requirements differ by jurisdiction: an attorney must review and adapt this document, and confirm it against the applicable rules of professional conduct, before it is used with a client.

This Agreement for Legal Services (the “Agreement”) is made between the law firm identified below (the “Firm”) and the client identified below (the “Client”). It states the work the Firm will do, what that work will cost, and what each party is responsible for. The Client should read it in full and ask about anything that is not clear before signing.

The parties

Firm	Responsible attorney	Date of this Agreement	
Firm address	Firm phone	Firm email	
Client (full legal name)	Additional client, if the Firm represents more than one		
Street address	City	State	ZIP
Client phone	Client email		

1. The matter and the scope of representation

Matter	Matter type

Nature of the matter (check all that apply):

- | | | |
|--|--|--|
| ☐ Family law | ☐ Criminal defense | ☐ Personal injury |
| ☐ Estate planning / probate | ☐ Business / commercial | ☐ Real estate |
| ☐ Immigration | ☐ Employment | ☐ Civil litigation |
| ☐ Bankruptcy / debt | ☐ Administrative / agency | ☐ Other (described below) |

Jurisdiction	Court or agency, if a case exists	Case number

Other party or parties	The Client's role or side

Description of the matter

Services the Firm agrees to provide in this matter

Stage of representation covered by this Agreement (check all that apply):

- | | | |
|---|---|---|
| ☐ Advice and counsel | ☐ Negotiation and settlement | ☐ Drafting and review of documents |
| ☐ Filing and trial-court proceedings | ☐ Contested hearing or trial | ☐ Appeal |
| ☐ Limited scope (described below) | ☐ Transaction or closing | ☐ Administrative hearing |

If the representation is limited in scope, state exactly what the Firm will and will not do

Services this Agreement does not cover

Appeals, enforcement or collection of a judgment or order, and any new or related matter are not covered unless this Agreement expressly says so. Work outside the scope stated above requires a separate written agreement or an amendment to this one signed by both parties. Other lawyers and staff of the Firm may work on the matter under the responsible attorney's supervision.

2. Fees

The Client agrees to pay for the Firm's services on the basis checked below. Only a checked arrangement applies to this matter; the subsections that are not checked are of no effect.

- | | | |
|--|---|--|
| ☐ Hourly fee | ☐ Flat fee | ☐ Contingency fee |
| ☐ Hybrid or other arrangement | ☐ Recurring / subscription fee | |

2.1 Hourly fees

Responsible attorney rate

Other attorneys of the Firm

Paralegals and law clerks

Time is recorded in increments of

0.1 hour (six minutes)

Minimum charge for a call or email

0.1 hour

Notice before a rate change

Billed time includes calls, correspondence, drafting, review, legal research, negotiation, discovery, preparation, travel, and court or agency appearances. Time is rounded up to the nearest increment stated above.

2.2 Flat fee

Flat fee for the services in section 1

Amount due at signing

How the flat fee is paid

A flat fee covers only the services described in section 1. If the representation ends before those services are complete, the Firm is entitled to the portion of the fee it has earned, measured by the work performed, and the Client is refunded the rest.

2.3 Contingency fee

Percentage before suit is filed

Percentage after suit is filed

Percentage if appealed

Costs and expenses are deducted from the recovery:

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Before the fee is calculated | ☐ After the fee is calculated |
|---|--|

How the recovery and the fee are calculated, including any structured settlement, lien, or subrogation claim

If there is no recovery, no attorney fee is owed. The Client remains responsible for costs and expenses under section 4 except as this Agreement states otherwise. Before any money is disbursed the Client will receive a written statement showing the amount recovered, the fee, and every cost deducted.

2.4 Hybrid or other arrangement

State the arrangement in full, including any reduced hourly rate, earned-on-receipt term, or success fee

2.5 Recurring or subscription fee

Recurring fee

Billed every

Notice to end the recurring engagement

thirty (30) days

The Firm has made no promise about the outcome of this matter, the total amount of fees, or how long the matter will take. Any estimate is a good-faith projection, not a cap.

3. Advance deposit and the client trust account

Advance deposit (retainer)

Replenishment threshold

Deposit due

The Client will deposit the advance with the Firm before work begins. The Firm holds it in its client trust account and applies it to fees and costs as they are billed and earned. The Firm will tell the Client when the trust balance falls below the replenishment threshold, and the Client agrees to restore the deposit promptly; the Firm may stop work if it is not restored. Any unearned balance is refunded to the Client when the representation ends.

Trust-account and advance-fee terms required in this jurisdiction

4. Costs and expenses

Costs and expenses are separate from fees and are the Client's responsibility. They include filing and court fees, service of process, court reporters and transcripts, records, expert and investigator fees, mediation and arbitration fees, electronic discovery, travel, and delivery charges.

Costs are:

☐ Advanced by the Firm and billed to the Client

☐ Paid by the Client as they are incurred

The Firm will obtain the Client's approval before incurring any single cost above

Cost deposit, if any

Additional terms about costs

5. Statements and payment

Statements are sent

Payment due after the statement date

Late charge on an overdue balance

fifteen (15) days

Each statement shows the work performed, the fees and costs charged, and any trust balance. The Client should review each statement promptly and tell the Firm of any question or disagreement within the time stated on it. The Firm may stop work, and may seek to withdraw, if a statement is not paid when due.

6. The Client's responsibilities

The Client agrees to be truthful and complete with the Firm; to provide requested documents and information promptly; to preserve documents, messages, recordings, and other records relating to the matter; to keep appointments and court dates; to report any change of address, telephone number, email address, or employment; and to make the decisions the law reserves to the Client, including whether to settle.

7. Communication and confidentiality

The Firm will keep the Client reasonably informed and will respond to inquiries within a reasonable time. Communications

between the Client and the Firm about this matter are confidential and protected by the attorney-client privilege. Sharing them with anyone outside the representation can waive that protection.

The Client consents to receiving communications about this matter by:

- ☐ Email ☐ Text message ☐ Telephone
☐ Secure client portal ☐ Postal mail ☐ Electronic signature

People the Firm may discuss this matter with (naming someone here permits disclosure to them; leave blank for none)

8. Payment by someone other than the Client

Third party paying fees, if any

Relationship to the Client

A third party who pays the Client's fees is not the Firm's client, has no right to direct the representation, and is not entitled to confidential information without the Client's written consent. The Client may withdraw that consent at any time. Time the Firm spends dealing with a third-party payor is billed to the Client.

9. Ending the representation

The Client may end this representation at any time by written notice. The Firm may withdraw to the extent the rules of professional conduct allow, including for non-payment or for a material misrepresentation by the Client, after reasonable notice and steps to protect the Client's interests. Withdrawal in a pending case requires court approval. If the representation ends, the Client remains responsible for fees earned and costs incurred through that date, and the Firm may apply trust funds to the outstanding balance.

10. The Firm's right to fees

To the extent the law allows, the Client grants the Firm a lien against funds held for the Client in the Firm's trust account and against any recovery in this matter, for fees earned and costs advanced. The lien is released when the balance is paid in full. Any award of attorney fees against another party does not make that party responsible to the Firm, and the Client remains responsible for the balance owed.

11. No guarantee of outcome

Nothing in this Agreement is a guarantee or prediction of any result. Legal matters are decided by courts, agencies, and opposing parties, whose decisions the Firm does not control. Any opinion the Firm gives about the matter is offered to help the Client evaluate it.

12. The file and its retention

The Firm retains the closed file for

File delivered on request as

At the end of the representation the Client may request the file. After the retention period above the Firm may destroy it without further notice.

13. Disputes about this Agreement

A dispute about fees under this Agreement will first be submitted to:

- ☐ Bar fee-dispute arbitration ☐ Mediation ☐ A court of competent jurisdiction

Venue for an action under this Agreement

Governing law

Dispute-resolution terms, including any notice or arbitration requirement

14. Terms required in this jurisdiction

Statutory or ethical language the jurisdiction requires in a fee agreement

15. Entire agreement

This document is the entire agreement between the Client and the Firm about this matter. It replaces any earlier discussion or understanding and may be changed only by a writing signed by both. If any provision is held unenforceable, the rest remains in effect.

By signing, the Client confirms having read this Agreement, having had the opportunity to ask questions about it and to consult another attorney about it, and agreeing to its terms. The Client is entitled to a signed copy.

Client signature	Date
Printed name	

Additional client signature, if any	Date
Printed name	

Attorney signature, for the Firm	Date
Printed name	Firm